

State’s airports may see big cut in flights

Amid U.S. shutdown, officials say LAX and other hubs face up to 1,800 fewer daily trips.

By JENNY JARVIE

California airports are expected to be hard hit by a dramatic reduction in flights as the Federal Aviation Administration says it plans to cut air traffic by 10% at 40 airports to maintain travel safety during the government shutdown.

Five of the state’s airports — Los Angeles International Airport, Ontario International Airport, San Diego International Airport, Oakland San Francisco Bay Airport and San Francisco International Airport — will be targeted for cuts, according to a list reviewed by news outlets.

Cuts are expected to begin Friday morning. As many as 1,800 flights a day across the country could eventually be canceled as the government shutdown goes into its second month. According to estimates from aviation analytics firm Cirium, nearly 10% of the cuts are likely to be at California airports.

“I’m not aware in my 35-year history in the aviation market where we’ve had a situation where we’re taking these kinds of measures,” FAA Administrator Bryan Bedford said at a Wednesday news conference. “We’re in new territory in terms of government shutdowns.”

Since the shutdown began Oct. 1, nearly 13,000 air traffic controllers have been working unpaid. With growing fatigue among controllers, Secretary of Transportation Sean Duffy said he did not want to wait until staffing challenges compromised safety.

“What we’re finding is that our air traffic controllers, because of the financial pressures at home, are taking side jobs. They need to put food on the table, gas in the car, pay their bills,” Duffy said.

“We do not want to see disruptions at the FAA or [See **Flights**, A14]



GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times

TRANSPORTATION Secretary Sean Duffy cited safety concerns. Above, travelers at LAX on Thursday.

Race for governor wide open as Porter’s support slips, poll shows

SACRAMENTO — A new poll shows that former Orange County Rep. Katie Porter’s support in the 2026 governor’s race dropped after she tangled with a television reporter during a heated interview in October, an incident that rival candidates used to question her temperament.

Porter was the front-runner over the summer but by late October dropped behind Riverside County Sheriff Chad Bianco, a Republican, according to a poll released Friday by the UC Berkeley Institute of Government Studies and co-sponsored by The Times.

Nearly half of voters undecided, but public focus may be turning toward the contest

By Phil Willon and Seema Mehta

Still, nearly half of the registered voters surveyed were undecided, evidence that few Californians are paying attention to a race that remains wide open and was eclipsed in recent months by the costly and successful congressional redistricting battle that became a referendum on President Trump. Porter remains the most favored Democratic candidate, which is significant in a state that has not elected a Republican governor since 2006.

“She’s the leading Democrat among [See **Poll**, A7]

Prop. 50 spurs blame game within GOP

Schwarzenegger is called ‘cowardly’; state party chair is urged to resign

By SEEMA MEHTA

Republican infighting crescendoed in the aftermath of California voters overwhelmingly approving a Democratic-friendly redistricting plan this week that may undercut the GOP’s control of Congress and derail President Trump’s polarizing agenda.

The state GOP chair-

woman was urged to resign and former Republican Gov. Arnold Schwarzenegger, who championed the creation of the state’s independent redistricting commission, was called “cowardly” by one top GOP leader for not being more involved in the campaign.

Leaders of the Republican-backed committees opposing the ballot measure, known as Proposition 50,

were questioned about how they spent nearly \$58 million in the special election after such a dismal outcome.

Former House Speaker Kevin McCarthy of Bakersfield, the once-prodigious Republican fundraiser, reportedly had vowed that he could raise \$100 million for the opposition but ended up delivering a small fraction of that amount.

Assemblyman Carl

DeMaio (R-San Diego), a conservative firebrand, called on state GOP Chair Corrin Rankin to step down and faulted other Republican leaders and longtime party operatives for the failure to defeat the ballot measure, calling them “derelict of duty and untrustworthy and incompetent.”

“Unless serious changes are made at the party, the [See **GOP**, A8]

PELOSI DECIDES NOT TO RUN IN 2026

Former speaker will leave the House after a momentous, nearly four-decade career.

By KEVIN RECTOR

SAN FRANCISCO — Rep. Nancy Pelosi, a trail-blazing San Francisco Democrat who leveraged decades of power in the U.S. House to become one of the most influential political leaders of her generation, will not run for reelection in 2026, she said Thursday.

The former House speaker, 85, who has been in Congress since 1987 and oversaw both of President Trump’s first-term impeachments, had been pushing off her 2026 decision until after Tuesday’s vote on Proposition 50, a ballot measure she backed and helped bankroll to redraw California’s congressional maps in her party’s favor.

With the measure’s resounding passage, Pelosi said it was time to start clearing the path for another Democrat to represent San Francisco — one of the nation’s most liberal bastions — in Congress, as some are [See **Pelosi**, A7]



BONNIE CASH For The Times

THE ex-House speaker joined Congress in 1987.

The right time

Rep. Nancy Pelosi made one of her typically calculated decisions, Mark Z. Barabak writes.

PERSPECTIVES, A2

Ever since the Trump immigration raids began in Los Angeles in June, local leaders and community activists have criticized agents for sometimes making it difficult to identify them as federal law enforcement officials or refusing to identify themselves at all.

Now, an unexpected new group has expressed its own concerns: the FBI.

Citing a string of incidents in which masked criminals posing as immigration officers robbed and kidnapped victims, the FBI recently issued a memo suggesting agents clearly identify themselves while they’re in the field.

The FBI explained its reasoning in a three-page document sent to police agencies across the country last month.

In the memo, the FBI says that criminals impersonating law enforcement “damages trust” between them and the community and that law enforcement has an “opportunity” to better coordinate with their local, state and federal partners. It calls for informational campaigns to educate

FBI calls for ICE agents to show IDs

Memo notes a string of crimes by people posing as federal officers

By NATHAN SOLIS AND RUBEN VIVES



CARLIN STIEHL Los Angeles Times

BORDER agents in L.A. in August. Criminals impersonating agents have robbed and kidnapped people.

the public about impostors and for agents to show their identification when asked while out in the field.

Undocumented immigrants and U.S. citizens have been detained by masked people on city streets, in hospitals and courthouses and outside schools and places of worship over the last several months. California has banned the use of masks among law enforcement agencies, but on Tuesday a cadre of masked agents gathered in an off-site Dodger Stadium parking lot while carrying out more raids.

The FBI’s memo, obtained through a records request by the national security transparency nonprofit Property of the People, was prepared by the New York field office and first reported by Wired magazine. It details several instances in which people impersonated immigration agents.

In Florida, a man pretending to be an Immigration and Customs Enforcement agent kidnapped a woman who was in the process of becoming a U.S. citizen. [See **FBI**, A14]

Election widens Republican divide

Democrats have been in crisis, but now the GOP must prepare for its post-Trump future.

By MICHAEL WILNER

WASHINGTON — Ahead of Tuesday’s election, when Americans weighed in at the ballot box for the first time since President Trump returned to office, a vicious fight emerged among the president’s most prominent supporters.

The head of the most influential conservative think tank in Washington found himself embroiled in controversy over his defense of Nick Fuentes, an avowed racist and antisemite, whose rising profile and embrace on the right has become a phenomenon few in politics can ignore.

Fierce acrimony between Fuentes’ critics and acolytes dominated social media for days as a historically protracted government shutdown risked food security for millions of Americans. Despite the optics, Trump hosted a Halloween ball at his Mar-a-Lago estate themed around the extravagance of the “Great Gatsby”

era.

Marjorie Taylor Greene, a congresswoman who rose to national fame for her promotion of conspiracy theories, took to legacy media outlets to warn that Republicans are failing the American people over fundamental political imperatives, calling on leadership to address the nation’s cost-of-living crisis and come up with a comprehensive healthcare plan.

And on Tuesday, as vote tallies came in, moderate Democratic candidates in New Jersey and Virginia who had campaigned on economic bread-and-butter issues outperformed their polling — and Kamala Harris’ 2024 numbers against Trump in a majority of districts throughout their states.

The past year in politics has been dominated by a crisis within the Democratic Party over how to rebuild a winning coalition after Trump’s reelection. Now, just one year on, the Republican Party appears to be fracturing, as well, as it prepares for Trump’s departure from the national stage and the vacuum it will create in a party cast over 10 years in his image.

“Lame duck status is going [See **Divide**, A8]

Gender-neutral passport ruling

By a 6-3 vote, justices allow the president to remove transgender markers from documents. **NATION**, A6

Subpoena seeks fire crews’ texts

Communications sought for smoke or hot spots in the Jan. 1 Lachman fire that preceded Palisades blaze. **CALIFORNIA**, B1

U.S. inks deal on weight-loss drugs

Pact with Eli Lilly and Novo Nordisk aims to expand coverage and cut prices for obesity treatments. **BUSINESS**, A11

Weather
Sunshine.
L.A. Basin: 80/58. **B6**

